THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 9: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Read: 'The Seth was holidaying in Kashmir. Oh, was that so? The elderly gentleman did not believe it.' The writer's attitude to the customer is: 1

(a) admiring **(b)** gently mocking **(c)** bitter **(d)** neutral

2. The sentence 'A few stones were thrown, and the manager retreated indoors' uses the passive voice mainly to: 1

(a) focus on the action rather than the unnamed throwers
(b) slow the story
(c) show the manager's courage
(d) show politeness

3. Choose the sentence in which 'bank' means something different from its meaning in the story: 1

(a) We walked along the river bank. **(b)** The bank closed at four.
(c) The bank manager was helpless. **(d)** He opened an account in the bank.

4. In the extract, 'The elderly gentleman did not believe it' shows that he: 1

(a) doubted the rumour
(b) investigated carefully
(c) trusted the telephone
(d) preferred his suspicion to the plain fact

5. Which element builds suspense in the story's middle? 1

(a) a long description of the hills
(b) the chain of whispered news moving closer to the bank
(c) the use of foreign words
(d) a sad song

6. If the manager had said 'the bank has ample money' (and the crowd believed him), the likely result would be: 1

(a) Nathu would be sacked
(b) the run on the bank would have been avoided
(c) nothing would change
(d) the bank would have collapsed sooner

7. Read: 'It was nearly closing time. The clerks shut down their counters.' What effect does this have on the crowd? 1

(a) It pleases them
(b) It makes them leave
(c) It calms them
(d) It adds to the suspicion that the bank is hiding something

8. The author's tone throughout the story is best described as: 1

(a) angry and bitter **(b)** tragic and grim
(c) solemn and religious **(d)** light, humorous and gently satirical

9. Choose the sentence that is correctly punctuated: 1

(a) We want it now! chanted the people. **(b)** "We want it now", chanted the people

(c) "We want it now!" chanted the people. **(d)** "We want it now" chanted, the people!

10. 'Others insisted that he had fled the country.' The word 'insisted' suggests that those people were: 1

(a) joking **(b)** hesitant

(c) stubborn about a belief without proof **(d)** well informed

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How does the repeated phrase 'the news spread' help the structure of the story? 2

12. How does the writer show the contrast between rumour and fact? 2

13. Explain how reading paragraph 30 aloud would convey Nathu's feelings. 2

14. Why is Faiz Hussain's customer called 'elderly gentleman', and what does it add? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Examine how the author uses repetition and escalation in the dialogue of paragraphs 6 to 16. 3

16. Analyse the role of language such as 'bird has flown' and 'forest fire' in the story. 3

17. Explain the difference between 'rumour' and 'news' using the story. 3

OR

Discuss the role of the setting (a small hill town) in making the rumour credible. 3

18. Write about the effect of the short final paragraph. 3

OR

Pick out two examples of understatement or dry humour from the story and comment. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Read: 'The news spread through the bazaar with the rapidity of a forest fire. From the general store it travelled to the tea-shop, circulated amongst the customers, and then spread with them in various directions.' 5

(a) What figure of speech is used?
(b) Why is it effective?
(c) What is the effect of the list that follows?
(d) Meaning of 'circulated'.
(e) What does it say about the town?

OR

Imagine you are Seth Govind Ram returning from Kashmir. Write a letter to the townspeople. 5

20. Read: 'Mischief-makers, who did not have a paisa in the bank, joined the crowd. The manager stood at the door and tried to calm his angry customers.' 5

(a) Who are mischief-makers?
(b) Why did they join?
(c) Which word shows the manager's role?
(d) Tone of the sentence?
(e) What does it show about crowds?

OR

Write a character sketch of the bank manager based on what the story shows. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks